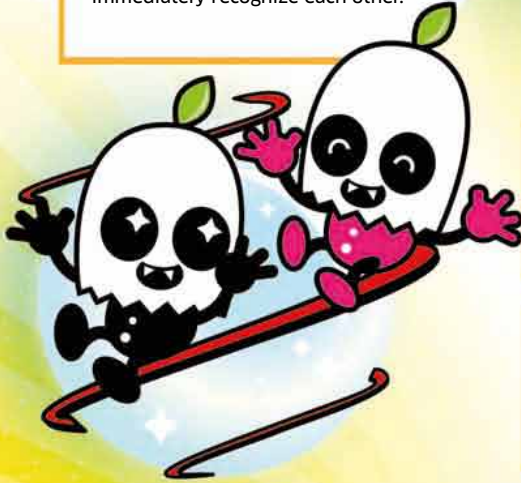


SIBLING BOND

The bonds of love and affection between brothers and sisters can be very strong, even after long periods of separation. When siblings who are parted in childhood meet years later as adults in crowded airport settings, they often immediately recognize each other.



FRIENDS FOREVER

As the saying goes, "Make new friends, but keep the old, one is silver, the other is gold." Close friends can be more open with each other than they are with partners or family members. Long-lasting ties of affection mean that they trust each other and feel able to speak honestly without the risk of hurt feelings.

HOLY DEVOTION

For people of a religious faith, love is of a supernatural or sacred nature. They show their love for God in regular worship and prayer and in other ways during their daily lives, such as doing volunteer work or caring for people who are sick or in trouble.



BROKENHEARTED

Being in love with someone who does not feel the same way about you is called unrequited love, and it can be a very painful experience. Unfortunately, most people go through unrequited love, especially during adolescence and early adulthood. Over time, hearts mend, and people go on to love again.



BABY LOVE

Psychologists believe that the close bonds of love forged between child and parent, or other family members, during the early years of life has a lasting influence on their later emotional and social development. Many mothers and fathers describe the love for their newborn child as stronger than any other they have known.

CHEMICAL RUSH

The classic symptoms of falling in love are sweating palms, pounding heart, loss of appetite, lack of concentration, and sleepless nights. This is due to the release of a chemical called phenylethylamine (PEA), found in food such as chocolate, and the sudden rush of excitement. PEA causes the release of other chemicals and stimulates norepinephrine, and serotonin. They surge together in the brain to create an emotional "high" that lasts for up to three years.

SMITTEN BY SMELL

People may choose partners who will give their children the best start in life—by smelling them! Everyone's immune system is controlled by a unique set of MHC genes. Research shows that people tend to prefer the body odor of a partner whose MHC genes are very different from their own. It could be because children born to parents with dissimilar immune systems are likely to have strong immune systems to fight illness.

